

GenAI: Powerful But *Risky*

Don't Trust What It Gives You

Job	Priority	IDX	Time
0	0	1	4
1	1	0	6
2	1	2	3

Job	Priority	IDX	Time
0	10	1	14
1	11	0	16
2	1	2	13

Don't Trust What It Gives You

```
int pagina = virtual_address / page_size;  
*VPN = pagina;
```

```
PTE* entrar = nullptr;  
if(!tlb->lookup(index, tag, &entrar))
```

```
int etiquette = VPN / k;  
*tag = etiquette;
```

```
int adresse = PFN * page_size + offset;  
return adresse;
```

```
int marco = TLB_lookup(tlb, VPN);
```


A Simple Program



```
OSSpring26 — ssh trucks — 80x24
...ibcheckData/SC21/bibcheck — bienz1@dane7:~/CG/src — -zsh ...
~/Programs/OSSpring26 — ssh trucks +

#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <string.h>
#include <dirent.h>
#include <sys/stat.h>
#include <unistd.h>

int main(int argc, char* argv[])
{
    FILE *fp = fopen("output.txt", "w");
    fprintf(fp, "Hello World\n");
    fclose(fp);

    system("rm output.txt");
}
~
```


A Simple Program

can I instead launch a new process and have it execute the program 'rm -rf *'?

Yes, but you should **not** do it exactly as `system("rm -rf *")` unless you fully understand the risks.

Great, GenAI knows not to do this... right?

A Less Simple Program

```
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <string.h>
#include <dirent.h>
#include <sys/stat.h>
#include <unistd.h>
```

```
int remove_directory(const char *path)
{
```

```
    struct dirent *entry;
    DIR *dir = opendir(path);
```

```
    if (!dir) {
        perror("opendir failed");
        return -1;
    }
```

```
    while ((entry = readdir(dir)) != NULL) {
        // Skip "." and ".."
        if (strcmp(entry->d_name, ".") == 0 ||
            strcmp(entry->d_name, "..") == 0)
            continue;
```

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```
char fullpath[1024];
snprintf(fullpath, sizeof(fullpath), "%s/%s", path, entry->d_name);
```

```
struct stat statbuf;
if (lstat(fullpath, &statbuf) == -1) {
    perror("lstat failed");
    closedir(dir);
    return -1;
}

if (S_ISDIR(statbuf.st_mode)) {
    // Recurse into subdirectory
    if (remove_directory(fullpath) != 0) {
        closedir(dir);
        return -1;
    }
} else {
    // Remove file (or symlink)
    if (remove(fullpath) != 0) {
        perror("remove file failed");
        closedir(dir);
        return -1;
    }
```

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```
    }

    closedir(dir);

    // Remove the now-empty directory
    if (rmdir(path) != 0) {
        perror("rmdir failed");
        return -1;
    }

    return 0;
}
```

```
int main(void)
{
    FILE *fp = fopen("output.txt", "w");
    fprintf(fp, "Hello World\n");
    fclose(fp);

    if (remove_directory(".") != 0) {
        fprintf(stderr, "Failed to remove directory\n");
        return EXIT_FAILURE;
    }
```

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GenAI just implemented `rm -rf \*` for you

Do NOT Trust Generated Code

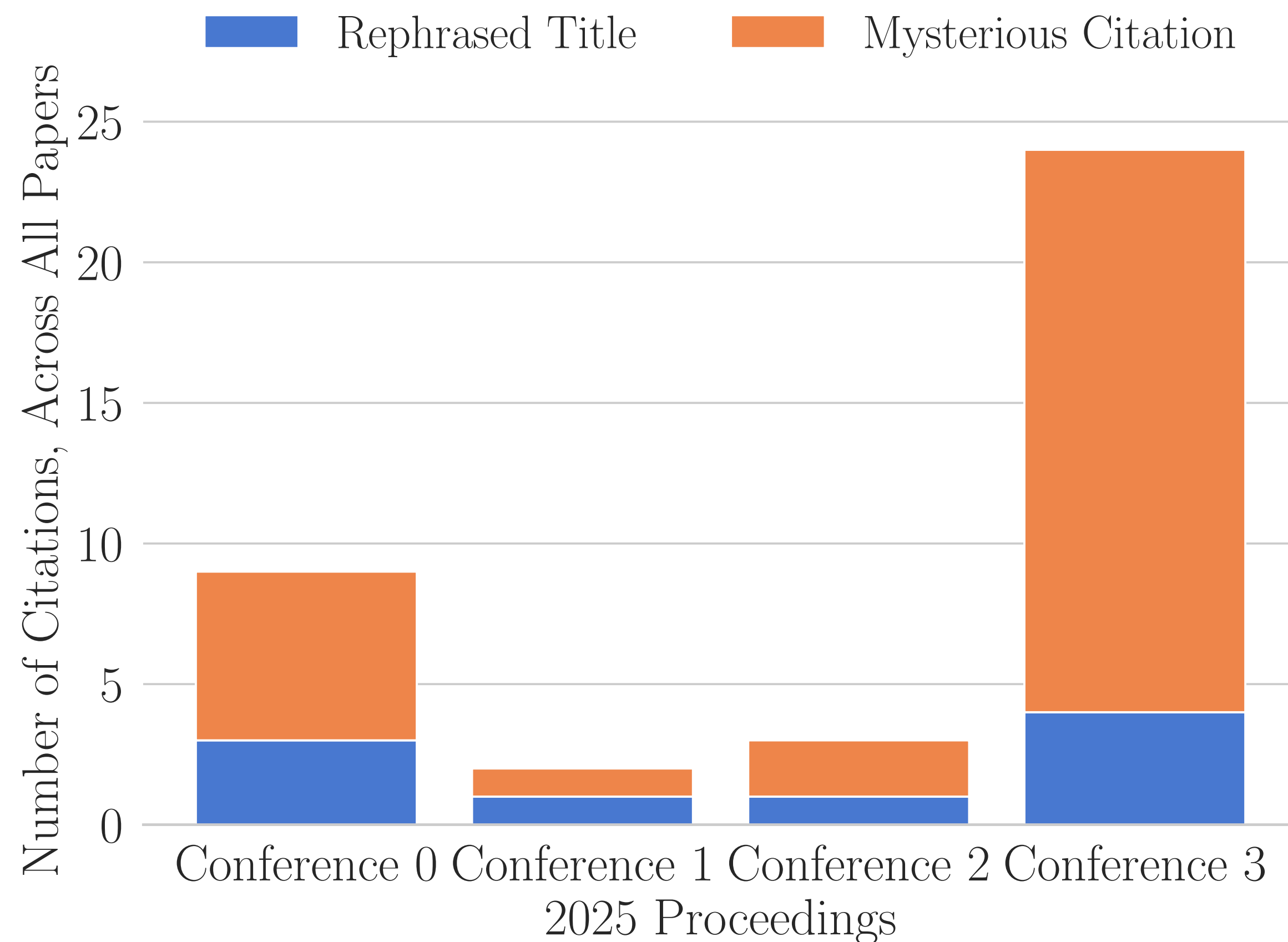
do I need sudo access to run this command `rm -rf /`

Do not run that command. It deletes every file on your system recursively — it will destroy your OS.

To answer your question: on most modern Linux systems, you *don't* need sudo because you likely have write permission to enough files to cause catastrophic damage anyway. Some distros add a `--no-preserve-root` safeguard that requires an extra flag, but don't rely on that.

There is no legitimate reason to run this command.

Always Verify



INVESTIGATIONS

FEATURED

GPTZero finds over 50 new hallucinations in ICLR 2026 submissions

GPTZero used our Hallucination Check tool to find 50+ hallucinations under review at ICLR, each of which were missed by 3-5 peer reviewers.



PAUL ESAU, NAZAR SHMATKO, ALEX ADAM
DEC 05, 2025 · 19 MIN READ

INVESTIGATIONS

FEATURED

GPTZero finds 100 new hallucinations in NeurIPS 2025 accepted papers

GPTZero's analysis 4841 papers accepted by NeurIPS 2025 show there are at least 100 with confirmed hallucinations



NAZAR SHMATKO, ALEX ADAM, PAUL ESAU
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By [Elizabeth Gibney](#)

